

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 3, 2018, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

OATH OF OFFICE FOR COUNCILORS, MAYOR AND ASSISTANT MAYOR

Gwen Melcher, City Clerk, administered the oath of office for the Mayor, Assistant Mayor and Councilors.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Also present:

Ryan McNutt, City Manager

Mayor Lovett said this meeting would be shortened to allow time for Councilors to go to the school budget public hearing.

Mayor Lovett said the New Councilor Orientation/Training would take place Saturday, January 6th, 9 a.m. to 12 noon in Council Chambers.

Mayor Lovett talked about the arctic cold weather. If people need heating assistance, they should call 211. She said according to the Director of Emergency Management, there is no shortage of oil in NH, however there is a shortage of delivery drivers. She said she called some local oil companies and was told that due to the extreme cold, residents should check their tanks, even if they are on auto delivery, to make sure they don’t run out of fuel.

Mayor Lovett said SB247, Lead Bill, was passed in the House. It will go to the Senate. The Governor supports this bill. During a press conference, the Governor pointed out the work that Claremont is doing to address this issue. Mayor Lovett suggested reaching out to Senator Hennessy to ask for her support on this bill.

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Mr. McNutt said if people have frozen pipes, they should not use an open flame to thaw them. Use a hair dryer or rags soaked in warm water wrapped around the pipes. He has opened the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center (CSBCC) to be used as a warming center. Membership is not required. Hours of operation: Monday-Thursday, 5:30 a.m. to 9:00 p.m.; Friday, 5:30 a.m. to 7:00 p.m.; and Saturday & Sunday, 8:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. If anyone has an emergency situation, they should call 911.

Mr. McNutt said if a tenant in an apartment building has no heat and is not able to get a response from the landlord, they should call the City Manager's office and the building inspectors will respond. Additionally, for residents who are having financial hardships and need fuel, they should contact the Welfare office or the City Manager's office.

Mr. Koloski said his restaurant has been sending out warm gear to local agencies and his restaurant still has supplies for anyone who needs help.

NEW BUSINESS

Overview

Moved to January 6th meeting.

New Councilor Orientation/Training

Moved to January 6th meeting.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 6:44 p.m., a motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council